

SOC-211

SOLVED PAST PAPERS SPRING 2021

SOLVED BY

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Past Paper Spring 2021

(I)

Differentiate between the following:

A) Achieved Status

Achieved status is a position a person earns through their own efforts, skills, or hard work. It is not given by birth but is gained by meeting certain goals or qualifications. For example, to become a member of the National Assembly in Pakistan, a person must meet the requirements, contest elections, and win. Similarly, to get a university degree, one must study hard, pass exams, and complete all requirements. So, becoming a degree holder or a leader is an achieved status because it needs time, effort, and ability.

B) Ascribed Status

Ascribed status is the position a person is born with and cannot change. It is given by society based on things like age, gender, caste, or family background. These statuses are not earned and do not depend on a person's talent or effort. For example, being born as a son, a brother, or belonging to a specific tribe or caste are all ascribed statuses. A person does not choose them, and they stay the same throughout life.

(II)

Write a note on the following:

A) Cultural Relativism

Cultural relativism means understanding and respecting other cultures without judging them using your own cultural standards. It teaches us that no culture is better or worse than another; they are just different. What is normal in one culture might seem strange in another, but that does not make it wrong. For example, eating habits, dressing styles, and traditions vary from place to place. Cultural relativism helps promote tolerance, peace, and acceptance among people. It is important for reducing cultural conflicts and misunderstandings.

B) Cultural Lag

Cultural lag happens when society's non-material culture (like values, beliefs, and laws) takes time to catch up with new technology or inventions. This causes a gap between what is possible with new technology and how people react to it. For example, mobile phones and the internet changed communication, but many people still misuse them or don't understand their full impact. Similarly, medical technology may advance faster than ethical or legal rules. Cultural lag can create confusion, problems, or even conflict in society. It shows that social values often change slower than scientific progress.

(III)

What is Social Interaction? Highlight processes of social interaction.

Social Interaction means how people act and react with each other in society. It builds relationships and communication.

Processes of Social Interaction:

Associative Processes (Positive)

These processes bring people together, build cooperation, and help in social unity.

i Cooperation

Cooperation means working together to achieve the same goal. People help and support each other. It creates unity and better results.

Example: Students work together on a class project.

ii Assimilation

Assimilation happens when someone slowly adopts the culture of others. They start living and behaving like the new group. It reduces differences between cultures.

Example: A village boy moves to a city and starts living like city people.

iii. Accommodation

Accommodation means adjusting with others to avoid fights or problems. People accept each other's differences. It helps people live peacefully.

Example: Two roommates adjust their habits to live together happily.

2. Dissociative processes (Negative)

Dissociative processes create distance, tension, or opposition among people. These include competition and conflict. Such interactions can lead to fights, jealousy, or misunderstandings. They may harm relationships or disturb social peace.

i. Competition

Competition means trying to do better than others. Everyone wants to win or be the best. Sometimes it's healthy, but it can also create pressure.

Example: Two students compete to get the highest marks in class.

ii. Conflict

Conflict happens when people strongly disagree or fight. It creates problems, anger, or misunderstanding. If not solved, it can harm relationships.

Example: Two neighbors fight over a parking space.

Long Questions

QNO.03

i. What is social control? Explain informal and formal social control in Pakistan society

Social control

Social Control is the way a society controls the behavior of its people to keep peace and order. It helps people know what is right or wrong and teaches them how to behave properly. Social control makes sure that everyone follows the rules, customs, and values of the society. It is done through family, schools, religion, laws, and other institutions. For example, parents teach good manners at home, teachers guide students in school, and the police make sure laws are followed. In this way, social control keeps the society safe, disciplined, and united.

i. Informal Social Control

In Pakistani society, informal social control is used through family, religion, culture, and traditions. People learn what is right or wrong from parents, elders, teachers, and religious leaders. For example, children are taught to respect elders, offer prayers, dress modestly, and speak politely. Society also controls people through praise, criticism, or fear of gossip. Although there are no written rules, people still follow these customs because they are deeply

rooted in everyday life. This type of control is very strong in homes, villages, and among close communities.

ii. Formal Social Control

Formal social control in Pakistan is based on written laws and official rules made by the government. It is carried out by institutions like the police, courts, schools, and other legal authorities. For example, if someone commits a crime like theft or violence, the police arrest them and the court gives punishment according to the law. This system helps maintain law and order in the country and protects citizens' rights. Formal control is more common in cities, workplaces, and public institutions where official actions are needed to handle serious issues.

QNO.03

ii. What is Socialization? Also discuss the Agencies of socialization.

Socialization:

Socialization is the process by which a person learns the rules, values, customs, and behaviors of their society. It starts from early childhood and continues throughout life. Through socialization, people learn how to talk, behave, respect others, and live in a group. Family, school, friends, religion, and media all play a big role in teaching us how to live in society. It helps people become responsible members of their culture and know the difference between right and wrong.

Agencies of Socialization

Socialization means learning how to live, behave, and interact in society. Different groups and institutions help a person learn values, rules, and culture — these are called agents of socialization. Below are the main agents:

1. Family

Family is the first and most important agent of socialization. It teaches a child how to talk, behave, respect elders, and follow traditions. Children learn religion, language, customs, and love from parents and siblings. The family also teaches what is right or wrong through daily actions and guidance. A strong family builds a child's personality, values, and habits.

2. Peer Group or Age Mates

Peer group means friends of the same age group. They play a big role, especially during school and teenage years. From peers, children learn how to share, play, cooperate, and sometimes even face peer pressure. They also learn how to adjust with others and build confidence. Peer groups help in developing social skills, hobbies, and group behavior.

3. Social Institutions (School, Religion, etc.)

Social institutions like schools, religious centers, and clubs also help in socialization. Schools teach discipline, rules, teamwork, and knowledge. Religion teaches moral values, like being honest, kind, and respectful. These institutions help people understand their duties and rights in society. They also shape a person's character and behavior.

4. Literature and Mass Media

Literature includes books, newspapers, and stories, while mass media includes TV, radio, internet, and social media. These sources teach people about current events, social issues, role models, and different cultures. They influence our thinking, fashion, language, and even our dreams. Media can have both positive and negative effects on people, especially youth. It is now one of the strongest agents of socialization.

5. Community

Community means the neighborhood or area where a person lives. It includes neighbors, local leaders, and common people. The community teaches how to live peacefully, help others, and respect local rules. Festivals, gatherings, and local events also help people connect and share cultural values. A good community helps in building trust, safety, and cooperation among people.

iii. What is Social Deviance? How does deviance affirm cultural values and norms?

Social deviance

Social deviance means any action or behavior that goes against the rules, values, or expectations of society. It includes acts like stealing, lying, or breaking social traditions. Deviance is not always negative—it can sometimes bring positive change, especially when someone challenges unfair rules.

Affirmation of Cultural Norms and Values:

When someone is punished for doing something wrong, it reminds society what is acceptable and what is not. For example, when a thief is sent to jail, it shows that stealing is wrong. Just like the idea of good is clearer when we know about evil, deviance helps us understand and strengthen our values and rules.

1. Clarification of Right and Wrong:

When people respond to wrong actions, it helps others know what is right or wrong. For example, if a student cheats and fails the course, it teaches the rest of the class that cheating is not allowed. This makes rules clear to everyone.

2. Unification of Others in Society:

When a deviant act happens, it can bring people closer emotionally. After the 9/11 attacks, people across the United States and even around the world felt sadness together. This shared feeling created a sense of unity and patriotism among citizens.

3. Promoting Social Change:

Sometimes deviant acts help bring good changes in society. For example, in 1955, Rosa Parks refused to give up her seat on a bus, which led to a major court decision ending bus segregation. Her action made society think about new and better rules.

4. Strain Theory of Deviance:

Strain theory says that when people try to reach goals approved by society but face obstacles, they may become frustrated. Not everyone has fair chances to succeed through legal ways. Sociologist Robert Merton said that when people feel blocked from success, they feel disconnected from society (called Anomie). This feeling can lead them toward deviant behavior.

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